

BUYERS' GUIDE

ESTYLE

Digital Blood Pressure MONITORING DEVICES

EFY BUREAU

Electronic blood pressure (BP) devices, also called BP monitors or digital monitors for BP, are battery-operated monitors that use a microphone to detect blood pulsing through the arteries. While you have the option of choosing between devices that measure BP at the upper arm, wrist or finger, the most-popular ones are upper-arm devices. This is because these are expected to give most-accurate and consistent results.

Buy what you can afford

BP monitors vary in price depending on the number of extra features that these have. Add-on features such as built-in memory could be helpful but might not be so necessary. At the most basic level, all you need is a clinically-validated monitor and a pen and paper to record the readings.

Hisao Masuda, MD, Omron Healthcare India, emphasises that, "Ideally, the device should be clinically validated for accuracy by a governing body such as National Ac-



A digital BP monitor for home use

Dr Morepen BP One BP09
fully-automatic BP monitor



creditation Board for Testing and Calibration Laboratories (NABL)."

A quick glance at online marketplaces like Amazon and Snapdeal indicate that almost all leading brands and models are available online. Because most marketplaces offer discounts, there are some models that are available at a very low price online as compared to pharmacies. At the time of writing this article, most devices were available within the price range of ₹ 1500 to ₹ 4000.

Important features for selection

Given below is a checklist of features you may want to review while selecting the device for you.

Cuff size. Make sure you have the right cuff size. An upper-arm BP monitor would come with a cuff that you need to wrap around your arm. If you use a cuff that is